PROSPER AWUNI

Senior SOC L3 Detection Engineer | SIEM Detection Engineering | Threat Hunting | MITRE ATT&CK | CrowdStrike | Microsoft Sentinel

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Detection Engineer with over five years of experience designing, building and continuously improving detection content across enterprise Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platforms. I specialise in CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, developing detection logic and Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework to counter advanced adversary techniques. I have hands-on experience building Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, conducting complex threat hunting investigations across cloud and endpoint environments, and leading incident response for high-priority security events. I combine deep technical detection engineering capability with a collaborative approach to mentoring and continuous improvement within Security Operations Centre (SOC) teams.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering:** SIEM analytics rule development, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection authoring, CrowdStrike custom Intelligence Detections (IOA), MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTP) mapping, detection lifecycle management
- **SIEM Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk / Search Processing Language (SPL) (moderate), alert correlation and tuning
- **EDR and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **SOAR and Automation:** Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) integration, Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, PowerShell scripting
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven threat hunting across SIEM and EDR telemetry, Indicators of Compromise (IOC) and Indicators of Attack (IOA) analysis, cloud and endpoint threat hunting
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure workload monitoring, hybrid environment security telemetry, cloud Identity and Access Management (IAM) hardening
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST 800-61 Incident Response, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer – University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Design, develop and continuously tune detection content across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, authoring Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules and CrowdStrike custom Intelligence Detections (IOA) mapped to MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) to counter active adversary activity.
- Lead hypothesis-driven threat hunting campaigns across endpoint, identity and cloud telemetry, proactively identifying novel attack patterns and translating hunting outcomes into new persistent detections.
- Own the incident response function for Priority 1 and Priority 2 security events, leading complex investigations through containment, eradication and recovery phases using NIST 800-61 methodology, and producing post-incident reports with detection improvement recommendations.
- Build and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that automate high-frequency alert workflows, reducing analyst toil and accelerating mean time to respond (MTTR) across the Security Operations Centre (SOC).

- Manage Identity and Access Management (IAM) security controls across Microsoft Entra ID, administering Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM) and Single Sign-On (SSO) policies to enforce Zero Trust principles and reduce identity attack surface.
- Oversee vulnerability management using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io and AppCheck, tracking remediation to closure and aligning posture improvements to CIS Controls and NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) benchmarks.
- Mentor junior analysts in detection development, alert investigation techniques and MITRE ATT&CK mapping, contributing to a continuous learning culture within the security team.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity – University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Developed and maintained a library of Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules covering phishing, credential theft, privilege escalation, lateral movement and data exfiltration, systematically improving coverage across the MITRE ATT&CK matrix.
- Deployed and administered CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) across the organisation's endpoint estate, configuring detection policies, tuning exclusions and investigating Falcon alerts during daily Security Operations Centre (SOC) operations.
- Led the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployment across an 8,000-user environment, integrating endpoint telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel to create a unified detection and correlation layer.
- Performed triage, investigation and escalation of security alerts from SIEM, EDR and email security platforms, documenting investigation findings and feeding outcomes back into detection tuning cycles.
- Authored and maintained SOAR automation workflows and incident response playbooks, ensuring consistent, repeatable and auditable handling of common security event types.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies and MFA controls, strengthening Identity and Access Management (IAM) posture across the enterprise.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports and coordinating with system owners to track issues to resolution.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure – HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Implemented and managed endpoint security controls, network access controls and cloud security measures across Microsoft Azure-hosted SaaS infrastructure, hardening the organisation's attack surface.
- Administered Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies to enforce device compliance baselines across a distributed workforce.
- Managed Azure Active Directory identity lifecycle controls including onboarding, offboarding automation and role-based access control (RBAC) configuration.
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities, producing audit evidence and contributing to remediation of identified control gaps.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised a comprehensive MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection library across CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, covering over 30 distinct TTP categories and directly reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) for high-priority threat scenarios.
- Led end-to-end deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and CrowdStrike Falcon across an 8,000-user UAL environment, delivering correlated SIEM and EDR telemetry in a unified extended detection and response (XDR) architecture.
- Developed automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks integrating BeyondTrust PAM and Sentinel Logic Apps, eliminating manual investigation steps from the most common alert types and significantly reducing analyst workload.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting campaigns that identified previously undetected adversary activity, each hunt resulting in net-new detection rules committed to the production SIEM environment.
- Achieved and maintained Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, underpinning expertise across detection engineering, IAM, incident response and security architecture.
- Implemented Zero Trust IAM controls via Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and Privileged Identity Management (PIM), reducing the identity-related attack surface across an 8,000-user enterprise estate.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (UK)